

LDR Committee Minutes

March 17, 2013, after the Across the Bay 12K One the benches above the west end of the post-race lawn Aquatic Park, San Francisco

Tom Bernhard, men's LDR chair and road scorer, Lloyd Stephenson, master's LDR chair, Tyler Abbott, Tim Wason, Chikara Omine, Excelsior; Don Porteous, cross country co-chair, Tamalpa; Irene Herman, PA president and membership chair, Impala; Bob Shor, Empire Runners; Mark Winitz, officials coordinator, Bill Dodson, MUT co-chair, WVJS; Hollis Lenderking, MUT co-chair, BAUR.

Meeting called to order 10:25 am.

Minutes from GGP meting 9/23/2012 unanimously approved. Lloyd Stephenson suggested he might clean up typos and grammatical errors.

SUBCOMMITTEE REPORTS

MUT: Bill Dodson reported on the progress of the 2013 Ultra Grand Prix.

Mountain/Trail Grand Prix Exploratory Committee (MoTEC): No report

Cross Country

The 2013 Cross Country Grand Prix was discussed. The discussion is shown below under "2013 Cross Country Grand Prix."

Sponsorship/Fundraising: No report.

Physically Challenged Athletes

Irene Herman reported that it has been challenging to find races willing and able to host a physically challenged division, but she and George Rehmet continue to work on it.

2013 CROSS COUNTRY GRAND PRIX

After some discussion, the 2013 Cross Country Grand Prix was unanimously approved. The tentative schedule appears in Appendix A.

2013 ROAD GRAND PRIX

It was announced that the Zippy 5K on 4/21 has been moved to Brisbane.

VOLUNTEERS

The LDR Committee is still looking for Board of Athletics members; no one stepped forward.

LDR BANQUET

There was a short discussion of the 2012-13 banquet sponsored by the Impalas and held the month before at Pyramid Brewery Berkeley.

Tom Bernhard mentioned that it might be wise to hold the 2013-14 banquet in the Sacramento area in the name of geographic diversity, and said he would try to contact some of the clubs up there.

LDR BUDGET: Nothing to report at this meeting.

RULES CHANGES

The following proposal:

"To change the descriptions of our age groups (from 'master,' 'senior,' etc.) to match national nomenclature ('40+,' '50+,' etc.) in our rules, results, standings, and anywhere else they appear on our website or literature" was unanimously approved. There was some discussion that we might continue to use the verbal (old) descriptions parenthetically after the numerical (new) descriptions in some instances.

Bill Dodson proposed adding an age group component to team scoring in the Ultra Grand Prix. This proposal appears in Appendix B and under LDR Committee rules will be voted upon at our next meeting.

Year-end Award Depth: No report

NEW BUSINESS

Rules Changes (new)

Tom Bernhard proposed that LDR Guide Rule 3.4 be changed as follows (new text in "**** **"):

LDR Committee meetings are held ***three times per year*** [strike "quarterly"] at a minimum. All LDR meeting announcements, agendas, minutes (as well as other official LDR mailings such as championships results) are ***posted on the PA website*** [strike "sent to one declared USATF contact for each club. This contact is the person specified when the club pays its annual PA/USATF dues. This contact may be changed only by written request sent to the Pacific Association office by the club president"].

Protests/Appeals: None

Other New Business

Hollis Lenderking brought up problems they have currently and have had historically with travel funding, in particular finding appropriate runners for the appropriate events in the appropriate time frame. The LDR Committee expressed that it would defer to the Ultra Subcommittee in this matter and gave that subcommittee license to change the award criteria, etc., as needed in order to effectively use the travel funding.

Mark Winitz asked the LDR Committee to consider the issue of foreign nationals. In particular, at the Credit Union Sactown 10 Miler last year, a foreign national who may or may not be a resident won and was awarded prize money as a PA member. Mark asked the committee to consider whether this presents an issue about which we might need to make rules, and to consider how to determine residency. One suggestion that someone must reside in the Pacific Association boundaries for three months before being eligible for prize money. Tyler Abbott believed we had established a policy on this in 2002 or 2003, using the "intent to reside within the Pacific Association boundaries for at least six months" as the standard.

No specific proposals were made.

Mark Winitz reminded the committee that there was a PA Strategic Planning session the Tuesday after the meeting. He asked the members of the committee whether they had any strategic planning ideas related to LDR.

Meeting adjourned 11:57 am.

Submitted by Tyler Abbott, acting LDR Secretary

APPENDIX A TENTATIVE 2013 CROSS COUNTRY GRAND PRIX SCHEDULE

08/17	Sat	13th Annual UC Santa Cruz XC Challenge	Santa Cruz
08/24	Sat	21st Annual Phil Widener Empire Open	Santa Rosa
08/31	Sat	3rd Annual Rebels XC Challenge	Sacramento (Granite Park)
09/08	Sun	28th Annual Golden Gate Park Open	San Francisco
09/14	Sat	2nd Annual NorCal XC Challenge	Redding
09/21	Sat	9th Annual Garin Park XC Challenge	Hayward
09/28	Sat	5th Annual Willow Hills XC Open	Folsom
10/05	Sat	15th Annual Presidio Challenge	San Francisco
10/26	Sat	16th Annual Shoreline Open	Hidden Valley, Martinez
11/02	Sat	18th Annual John Lawson Tamalpa Challenge	China Camp
11/17	Sun	4th Annual Ancil Hoffman Challenge	Sacramento
11/24	Sun	28th Annual PA Cross Country Championships	San Francisco

APPENDIX B

ULTRA GRAND PRIX "AGE GROUP" TEAM SCORING PROPOSAL

To add 3 more team divisions designated as Age Group, restricted to ages to be set at the beginning of each year by the MUT subcommittee, somewhat like the division between long and short Road races. There would be one division for each of Men, Women and Mixed. The age restriction may be different for the 3 divisions.

Keep the current divisions designated as Open, with no age restrictions.

An Age Group runner may be scored either as a Age Group or Open runner but may be scored only once. A runner under the Age Group restriction may be scored only as an Open runner. This is the same as 'moving down' in road and XC races.

Following are some numbers derived from the 2013 Jed Smith and Way Too Cool results (includes only PA members).

	Total finishers	Under 40	40+	Under 50	50+
Men	92	21	71	49	43
Women	38	10	28	27	11
Mixed	131	31	99	76	54

My guess from these numbers is that we would choose 50 for men and mixed.
For women, 40 would probably be best in order to have enough Age Group women.

The term Age Group is based on UltraRunning Magazine's Age Group Performances for the Year (UR uses 50 for both men and women).